

# Toh 414 in the Kangyur is a tantric scripture known in Sanskrit as the Anābhila

Toh 414 · Derge Kangyur

Toh 414 in the Kangyur is a tantric scripture known in Sanskrit as the Anābhila Tantra and in Tibetan as the Dpal 'khor lo sdom pa'i rgyud kyi rgyal po dur khrod kyi rgyan rmad du byung ba, which may be rendered in English as something like the Wondrous Charnel Ground Ornament, a King of Tantras of Glorious Chakrasaṃvara. It belongs to the class of Highest Yoga Tantras associated with the Chakrasaṃvara cycle, a tradition of great importance in Vajrayāna Buddhism centered on the deity Chakrasaṃvara and his consort. The text opens with an invocation to the vajra ḍākinī and proceeds to expound the ultimate nature of awakening — described as beyond marks, analogies, and conceptual elaboration — in a manner characteristic of advanced tantric instruction aimed at guiding practitioners toward direct realization. It was translated into Tibetan by the Indian paṇḍita Gayadhara together with the monk-translator Śākya Yeshe, placing it within the broader corpus of Indian tantric literature transmitted to Tibet during the great translation period.

---

Homage to the vajra ḍākinī.

Wishing to benefit sentient beings,  
I shall set forth the unobscured teaching in full.  
Beyond appearances, beyond analogy,  
transcending entirely the domain of words,  
peaceful, selfless, utterly pure,  
free from marks, having abandoned every basis for marks —  
such is the nature of awakening in its natural state.  
Abandoning every basis for marks,  
I have set this forth with clarity, in brief and condensed form.  
Wishing to benefit those who are confused,  
I have taught this out of compassion.

Some assert it as emptiness,  
some as a form endowed with a subtle sphere,  
some establish it for those of lesser understanding  
in the manner of an all-pervading presence.  
Genuinely and definitively confirmed as that very reality,  
it is the domain of experience at the level of the cause.

If cause and result are not established,  
there is no meditation and no awakening.  
This self — beginningless and endless —  
which has abandoned trust in causes  
arises from illusory wisdom  
and displays itself in manifold appearances.

Some are of a wrathful nature,  
some are exceedingly great and peaceful,  
some appear in forms bearing the nature of mudrā,  
some are trembling and moving.  
Similarly there are song and dance, and melodies,  
and the recitation of divine mantras.  
Some correctly set forth mantras,  
some draw maṇḍalas,  
and there is the investigation of empowerment and so forth,  
and the body composed of the elements and of what arises from the elements.  
So too, infinitely, the supreme:  
buddhas and the rest are investigated through the vajra.

When the mind abides well,  
that is the domain of experience of suchness itself.  
That the maṇḍala transforms accordingly  
is something those who wish to benefit should know.  
That which is elaborated through the aggregate of the aggregates and other  
collections,  
modified by their distinguishing characteristics,  
and refined through body, speech, and mind —  
this is taught as the maṇḍala of colored powders.  
Because the aggregates and other things are seen among other collections,  
this is taught as the maṇḍala of the assembly.  
The maṇḍala of mind, being pure,  
is to be meditated upon as being without inherent nature.  
Single, like a mirror:  
this is to be understood first in the eastern quarter.  
Because it is taught as discriminating wisdom,  
the eastern quarter is fully adorned.  
Supremely distinguished activity and diligence

are elaborated in the northern quarter.  
The great wisdom of equality  
realizes the non-habitual-tendency quarter in subsequent cognition.  
In other respects too, the maṇḍala is four-sided,  
the center of the quarters being in every direction.  
Through thorough entry into that very reality,  
investigate it as the domain of wisdom's experience.

The correct statement of the four gates  
arises accordingly as the fourfold mindfulness.  
And what is taught as the four quarters  
is the fourfold generosity in its pure form.  
In the center the form of the maṇḍala  
is fully adorned by Akṣobhya.  
Adorned through peace and the meaning of the Dharma,  
all of these accomplish the maṇḍala.

The net, the half-net, the moon, and so forth,  
which are painted within the maṇḍala,  
together with the archway and all the rest —  
the archway is the limb of meditative absorption.  
This is spoken of as the ultimate expression of mind,  
taught from the standpoint of reality's intrinsic nature.  
Whatever is the flourishing expansion of the mind,  
the limb of meditative absorption abides:  
that very thing is taught as the net.  
The half-net is the half,  
and the investigation of bells and garlands  
brings understanding of one's own consort.  
Like the appearance of an echo,  
all phenomena are individually discerned.  
Because one sees the unborn nature of all phenomena,  
that very reality is taught as the garland of victory banners.  
Whatever is placed on the canopy and so forth —  
first determine objects and so forth.  
The mind is explained as the canopy:  
this is taught from the standpoint of the supreme meaning.  
All those garments and garlands

are simply the appearance of manifold aspects.

This completes the glorious King of Tantras of Cakrasaṃvara, the Wondrous Ornament of the Charnel Ground. It was translated by the paṇḍita Gāyadhara and the translator, the fully ordained monk Śākya Yeshé.

In the Indian language this text is entitled Anābhīlatantra-rāja-nāma. In the Tibetan language it is entitled The Tantra-King Called the Unobscured. Homage to the vajra ḍākinī.

One whose mind is of the nature of vajra,  
marked by the gnosis of joy,  
is always taught to be beneath it.  
At every corner of the precinct,  
adorned with vajra and jewel  
for the sake of realizing vajra and jewel —  
what is taught as moon and sun  
is for seeing the meaning of skillful means and wisdom.  
The mind, whose very nature is skillful means and wisdom,  
is adorned by this gnosis.  
Born from the vajra of body, speech, and mind,  
that very thing is taught to be the maṇḍala.  
Because body, speech, and mind are proximate,  
they cannot be characterized as a single form.  
The authentic entry into this  
is taught to be made clear for masters and students.

The fire offering too — I shall now explain it:  
I proclaim the satisfaction of the gods.  
That mind which is free from conceptual thought  
is precisely what is designated by the term "hearth."  
By splitting the kindling, into the fire within,  
the five — the aggregate of form and the rest —  
which are the fuel-wood arising from mind,  
all are to be burned in this manner.  
Whatever arises as form and so forth  
is well known as "fuel-wood."

Having thus explained the fire offering,  
the permanent abiding is to be described.

One who has made the mind stable  
in body, speech, and mind at all times —  
that is precisely what is called permanent abiding.  
Whatever the entities of the aggregates may be,  
and whatever bears the characteristic mark of mantra —  
that is to be clearly stated.  
And by the minds, in the language of sound,  
I have expressed what is secret:  
without arising and without appearance,  
free from basis of designation and from defining characteristic —  
for the sake of realizing the secret meaning,  
I have taught this as mantra.

Having clearly explained mantra,  
the deities too are to be described.  
Whatever is the excellent abiding in the intrinsic nature  
of the aggregates, the elements, and the sense bases,  
which is true awakening and liberation itself —  
having examined all of that correctly,  
if one examines the mind closely,  
that is correctly taught as "deity."  
That very thing is also correctly taught  
through the mudrā of body, speech, and mind.  
The yoga of petitioning the deity —  
I shall clearly expound it.

Then, having taken the cross-legged posture  
and directing the gaze toward the tip of the nose,  
the yogin should settle in the seeing  
of the reality of one's own intrinsic nature.  
With both hands placed at the region of the heart,  
joined together with effort,  
when the mind flows forth  
in the nature of non-conceptuality,  
the lord who embodies all buddhas  
will come to birth in that one at that moment.  
The lord who embodies all buddhas  
will swiftly bestow blessing.

The lord who embodies all buddhas,  
the lord who holds the vows of all buddhas —  
as has been taught by the mind-vajra,  
through yoga one becomes all buddhas.

What I clearly proclaim  
is the granting of the attainment of body, speech, and mind,  
the secret meaning supreme among all buddhas,  
the object domain of skillful means and wisdom,  
great compassion for the sake of sentient beings,  
the supreme accomplishment of the buddha-element.  
I have taught the maṇḍala of the tip of the nose.  
All of these have been summarized  
in brief, merely in outline — not fully expounded.  
Sometimes the samaya wheel too  
was not taught under the name "suchness."  
Whatever is accomplished through even a little realization  
is sometimes taught as the speech wheel.  
The supreme practitioner should accomplish it  
with fervent devotion, free from conceptual thought.

Blood and semen, likewise flesh,  
excrement and urine —  
I have uttered these words to be strenuously  
what is called the samayas.  
In all of these, a Tathāgata is present;  
they abide only as conventional designations.  
When the samaya is approached with a mind of desire,  
one thereby engages with reality itself.  
But when the mind becomes attached,  
there is no sentient being there —  
and upon that one, conceptual thought  
will come to consume its blood.  
Having consumed the great blood,  
Amitābha too is to be consumed.  
Whatever arises from phenomena  
is to be proclaimed with the sound of semen.  
At that time, for the sake of realizing the unborn,

eating is correctly taught.

The equality of all things —

The great flesh is thoroughly distinguished.

Through the yoga of non-observation,

what is eaten is explicitly proclaimed.

That mind which flows forth abundantly,

through the application following upon potency —

through the mudrā and karmic application —

that too is proclaimed with the sound of urine.

This abiding within the rain of the hidden,

the mind certain regarding what is Dharma and what is not,

is the thorough realization of all phenomena.

Eating excrement is correctly proclaimed.

The defining characteristic of the samaya itself —

all of these are clearly explained.

By realizing the meaning of all these,

one becomes the very identity of all buddhas.

The glorious Uttarasukha, which brings about realization —

## Translator's Notes

• The colophon placed at the opening belongs to the preceding text, the Cakrasaṃvara tantra called the Wondrous Ornament of the Charnel Ground. What follows is a separate tantra, the Anābhīlatantra-rāja (Tibetan: Rgyud kyi rgyal po rnyog pa med pa), its Sanskrit title preserved in the colophon. The translator pair is the same paṇḍita Gāyadhara and the Tibetan monk-translator Śākya Yeshé, a well-known collaborator active in the eleventh century.

The central cosmological and ritual analysis of the maṇḍala in the verse body is dense and allusive. The passage discussing "some assert it as emptiness, some as a form endowed with a subtle sphere" refers to competing Vajrayāna and Śaiva metaphysical positions; the term "subtle sphere" renders thig le, the Skt. bindu, a key tantric category. The rendering "self — beginningless and endless" for thog ma tha ma med pa'i bdag reflects the tantra's rhetorical appropriation of this loaded term in a non-eternalist sense; the doctrinal inversion is deliberate in the text.

• The closing line is syntactically incomplete in the source as given, ending mid-phrase. This appears to be a passage break at the end of the supplied text, not a corruption; the translation accordingly renders it as an unfinished sentence leading into what follows.

The phrase rendered "lord who embodies all buddhas" translates a compound meaning literally "the lord of the assembly of all buddhas." This is a technical epithet for the central tantric deity as the unified embodiment of all buddhas; "lord" is used consistently for this honorific throughout.

The "maṇḍala of the tip of the nose" is an inner or subtle-body maṇḍala located at the tip of the nose as a meditation focal point, consistent with the inner yoga framework of the text.

- The passage is a segment of a Vajrayāna tantric text employing the characteristic "twilight language" (Skt. sandhyābhāṣā), in which substances such as flesh, urine, and excrement function simultaneously as literal ritual substances and as coded references to inner yogic and doctrinal realities. The rendering preserves the literal register, as the tradition itself operates on both levels at once and neither should be suppressed. The final line appears to be a title or colophon fragment introducing the next section; "Uttarasukha" renders འཁོར་ལྷ་མོ་ as a proper name meaning "the Glorious Supreme Bliss," which in context is likely the name of the tantra or a chapter thereof.

---

## Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.